

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠2

Board: 2
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠4

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦4

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥2

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥3

Board: 6
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠10

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5
 ♥ K Q J 3
 ♦ 9 7 6 4
 ♣ Q 10 9

♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5



♠ 6 2

♥ A 10 8 4

♦ 10 8 2

♣ K J 4 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A 8 6 3

EAST's 1♥ opening is passed around to NORTH. He is tempted to overcall 1♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points SOUTH is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2♣.

NORTH now bids 2♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

SOUTH raises to 4♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♥	Pass
Pass	Dbl	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♠2			

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ A 9 7 6
 ♦ A 6 2
 ♣ K 9 6 3

♠ Q 10 3 2
 ♥ 5 3 2
 ♦ J 8 5 3
 ♣ 7 4



♠ A J 9
 ♥ K Q 8
 ♦ Q 7 4
 ♣ A Q 8 5

♠ K 6 5 4
 ♥ J 10 4
 ♦ K 10 9
 ♣ J 10 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♠	1NT	Pass
2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 4			

EAST has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

WEST bids 2 ♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When EAST denies holding a 4-card Major WEST has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since EAST promised he had the suit controlled.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 4 3
♥ A 8 3
♦ 5 4 3 2
♣ 10 7 5

♠ J 10 5 2

♥ 7 6 4 2

♦ 8 6

♣ J 8 6



♠ K Q 9

♥ 10 9 5

♦ K Q 10

♣ A 9 3 2

♠ A 8 6

♥ K Q J

♦ A J 9 7

♣ K Q 4

SOUTH has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

NORTH has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming SOUTH wants to hear his best suit.

SOUTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. NORTH passes, of course.

West	North	East	South
		1♦	Dbl
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
All Pass			
1NT by South			
Lead: ♦4			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 7 4
♥ A Q 10
♦ K J 7 5
♣ A K 6

♠ 9 8 5
♥ K J 8 2
♦ 8 6 4
♣ J 10 3



♠ K J 6 2
♥ 6 5
♦ A Q 3
♣ 9 8 7 4

♠ A 10 3
♥ 9 7 4 3
♦ 10 9 2
♣ Q 5 2

WEST has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

EAST has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2♠.

In theory WEST could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♥
Dbl	Pass	2♠	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥2			

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7
 ♥ Q J 10 9
 ♦ 9 5 4
 ♣ K Q 6 5

♠ A Q 10 5 3

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 10

♣ A 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 6

♥ K 7 3 2

♦ A 8 7 6

♣ 10 8 3

♠ K J 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3 2

♣ J 2

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 3

North

1 ♠

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

3 ♠

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points NORTH should overcall 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If NORTH had opened, SOUTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since NORTH overcalled, SOUTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

NORTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 6 4

♥ J 10 7 5

♦ 6

♣ A K J 3

♠ A 7 5

♥ 3 2

♦ Q J 9 7

♣ Q 10 7 6



♠ Q 3

♥ K Q 9 8 6 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 9 5

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ A

♦ K 10 8 4 3

♣ 8 4 2

WEST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦.
But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with
perfect distribution.

EAST has 13 points and only wants to play in one
contract, 4♥.

WEST passes happily.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Dbl

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♠10